



/// Backstory

BACKSTORY EBOOK SERIES

MCP Server & Tools

*Ask Backstory anything — from inside
whatever AI tool you're already using.*

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 **Backstory**





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CHAPTER 1

What Is MCP and Why Does It Matter?

*From copy-paste to live intelligence —
one question, one answer.*

What is MCP and Why Does It Matter?

Backstory MCP is a secure connection that allows AI assistants and programmatic agents to safely access your Backstory sales data using the Model Context Protocol (MCP), an open standard for connecting AI tools to external data sources.

The Manual Way (Without MCP)

Switch to Backstory, find the account, read the summary, copy key points, switch back to your AI tool, paste context, then ask. **Four steps** before you get an answer.

The AI Native Way (With MCP)

Ask your question in Claude or Copilot. The AI calls Backstory directly, retrieves live data, and answers in **under 10 seconds**.
Supported Clients: Claude, ChatGPT, Microsoft Copilot, Google Gemini, and n8n.

How it fits the Backstory platform

Backstory captures activity (Step 1), Revenue Reasoning interprets them (Step 2), and delivers answers (Step 3). MCP is a new surface for Step 3, providing live access to accounts, deals, and pipeline data so you can make data-driven decisions (Step 4).



Backstory turns what's happening into what to do next.

Activity

Backstory ingests:

-  EMAILS
-  CALLS
-  MEETINGS
-  CHATS

Revenue Reasoning

Backstory analyzes:

-  FILTERS ACTIVITIES
-  CONNECTS ACTIVITIES
-  ADDS CONTEXT
-  DISTILLS OUTPUTS

Answers

Backstory reveals:

-  WHAT'S HAPPENING
-  WHAT'S NOT
-  WHERE DEALS STAND
-  WHO MATTERS

Decisions

What to do next:

-  REAL-TIME COACHING
-  COMMIT OR CUT
-  SAVE IT OR MOVE ON
-  BUILD THE CASE



How Authentication Works



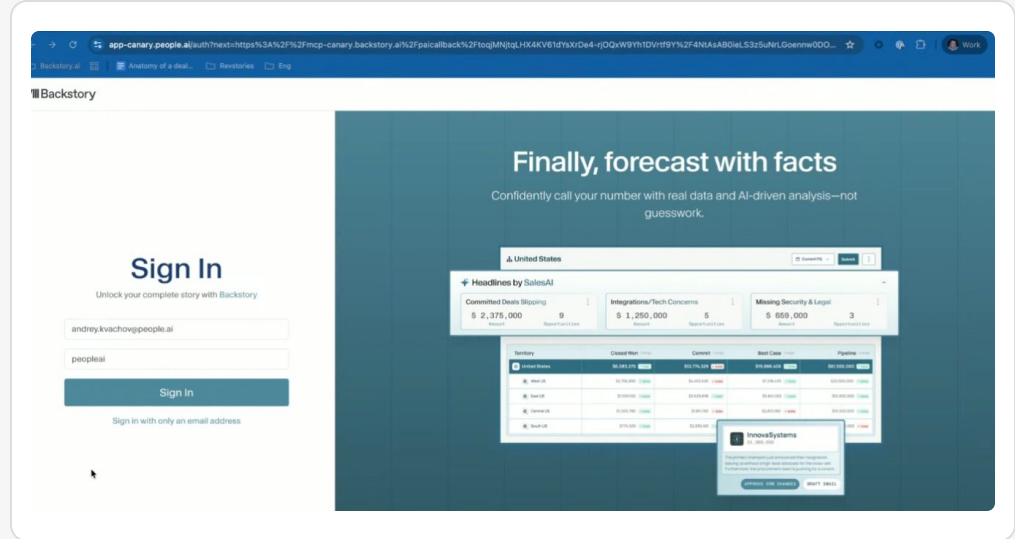
Backstory Credentials

Sign in directly through the Backstory app login using your existing credentials.



No CRM Seat Required

You do not need an active CRM seat to authenticate.



BACKSTORY MCP

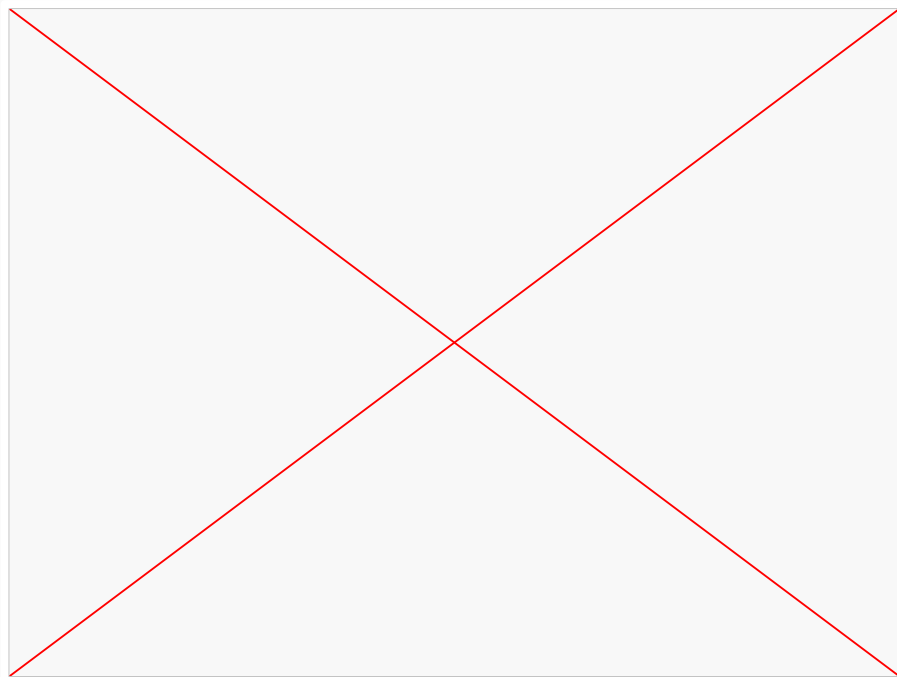
Intelligence that lives *where work happens.*

Revenue leaders don't need more dashboards. You need answers to the questions that keep you up at night.

Backstory solves this challenge by turning activity signals into clear answers to close deals faster and grow pipeline predictably.

Model Context Protocol (MCP) delivers Backstory's Revenue Reasoning directly into the tools your team already uses - Claude, Copilot, or ChatGPT.

[Take the tour](#)





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CHAPTER 2

The 8 MCP Tools

Eight purpose-built tools organized by intelligence type.

The 8 MCP Tools — Four Groups

Workflows start with Discovery, then utilize Intelligence and AI Assistant tools to retrieve deep account and deal data.

Account Discovery

Tools

`find_account`
`find_record_by_id`

Best For

The mandatory start. Locates correct records for the workflow.

Account Intel

Tools

`get_account_status`
`get_recent_activity`

Best For

Health snapshots, risk assessment, and communication history.

Opportunity Intel

Tools

`get_opp_status`
`get_recent_opp_activity`

Best For

Deal health, buyer engagement, and next steps for deals.

AI Assistant Tools

Tools

`ask_sales_ai_account`
`ask_sales_ai_opportunity`

Best For

Expert insights, strategic analysis, and recommendations.

How the tools chain together

The AI handles sequencing automatically — you just ask your question. No need to know tool names.



Account Discovery & Management

These tools are the starting point for almost every MCP workflow, locating accounts and opportunities in Backstory.

`find_account`

Purpose

Locates an account by name. Returns Backstory account ID, domain, name, and linked opportunities.

Best For

Starting point for every account or deal question. The AI calls this first automatically.

`find_record_by_crm_id`

Purpose

Locates a specific account or opportunity using a Salesforce Record ID as the lookup key.

Best For

Use when you have a Salesforce record ID and want to pull it into an MCP workflow without searching by name.

Important: Account Name Matching

Account names must match Salesforce exactly. Minor differences (abbreviations, punctuation, spacing) can cause no-match results. Try a shorter version, or use `find_record_by_crm_id` with the Salesforce ID.



Account Intelligence Tools

Three specialized tools providing varying depths of account insight, from quick health snapshots to external public data.

`get_account_status`

What It Returns

AI-analyzed overview: risks, next steps, and key discussion topics.

Best For

Pre-call prep, QBR preparation, and identifying renewal health risks quickly.

`get_recent_activity`

What It Returns

Full communication history with extracted facts and strategic insights.

Best For

Deep dives into key calls and investigating why engagement has dropped (30-day window).

`account_company_news`

What It Returns

Categorized recent news: M&A, Org Changes, and Financial Performance.

Best For

External research for public firms to identify strategic outreach triggers.

Important Coverage Notes

Recent Activity analyzes 30 days of data. Company News is restricted to publicly traded companies; private company returns will be empty.



Opportunity Intelligence & AI Assistant Tools

Expert analysis grounded in your deal data for strategic account management.

Tool	What It Returns	Best For
<code>get_opportunity_status</code>	AI-analyzed deal overview: risks, next steps, key discussion topics.	Pipeline review prep. Quick status checks before forecast calls.
<code>get_recent_opportunity_activity</code>	Detailed history focused on opportunity-specific interactions.	When you need granular detail on commitment or engagement.
<code>ask_sales_ai_about_account</code>	Natural-language Q&A: adoption, stakeholder map, scorecard.	PBR/QBR prep, expansion planning, and strategic questions.
<code>ask_sales_ai_about_opportunity</code>	Specific deal context: "Is this deal at risk?" / "Who is the economic buyer?"	Coaching, win/loss analysis, and deal handoffs.

Status vs. Ask Sales AI

Get Status tools provide a quick read. Ask Sales AI is for complex questions requiring synthesis and recommendations. Use it for answers, not just summaries.



MCP Tools and Use Cases

Your client connects to Backstory, which merges and matches team communication data with CRM records for a unified view of activity.

Looking Up Records

Find Account: Search by name for matched records and CRM attributes.

Find Record by CRM ID: Resolve Salesforce IDs directly to Backstory.

Top Records: Returns the most relevant accounts based on engagement.

Analysis & Overview

Account/Opp Status: AI summaries of health, risks, and next steps.

Scorecard: Retrieves structured Closeplan Q&A data.

Situation Search: Analyzes current deals to find similar historical wins.

Activity & AI

Recent Activity: View the last 30 days of team communications.

Engaged People: List of contacts active in the last 30 days.

Ask Sales AI: Natural language questions for full context answers.



Connect a Third-Party AI Assistant

You can connect Backstory MCP to third-party AI assistants so your team can ask questions about Backstory data without leaving the tool they already use.

Claude

See [Connect](#)

ChatGPT

See [Connect](#)

Google Gemini

See [Connect](#)

MS Copilot

See [Connect](#)

n8n

See [Connect](#)

Authentication

OAuth 2.0 with Dynamic Discovery (Primary Path): The primary authentication path for end-users is through OAuth 2.0 with Dynamic Discovery. This path uses Salesforce as the identity provider to log into the Backstory application (glass.backstory.com/ai). Users logging in through this path must already be able to log in to the Backstory application using their Salesforce credentials.

Alternative Paths: Backstory also offers alternative authentication paths that receive encoded credentials provided by your internal IdP (e.g. Okta, Entra ID) via your chosen chat client. Reach out to your account team to discuss integration options.

Note: Adding Backstory MCP as a custom connector requires administrator access in your AI tool.



Situation Search

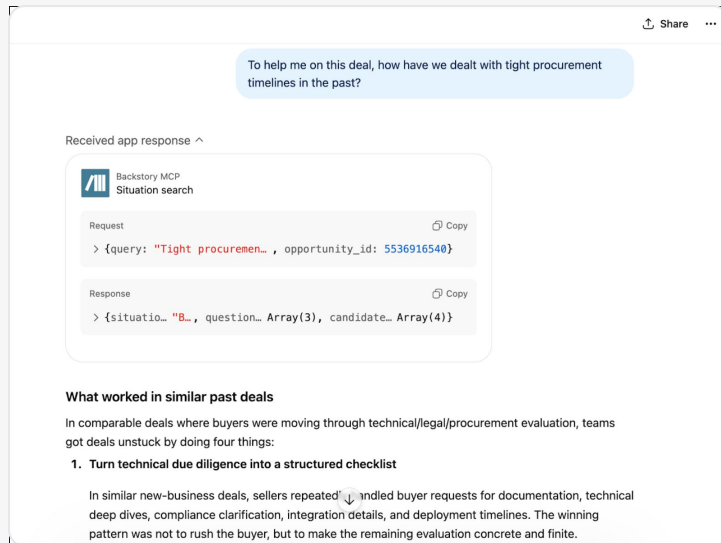
Situation Search is a tool that lets you describe your current deal in plain language and returns comparable historical deals from your organization.

Results include deal profiles and winning tactics, helping you learn from past wins without relying on personal networks.

Note: This feature is in beta. Requires organization enablement via Backstory.

How to use Situation Search:

- Open your chat client connected to the Backstory MCP server.
- Describe your deal (e.g., "stuck at procurement")
- Submit the query
- Your LLM will work with you to identify winning tactics to apply



Pro Tip: Use specific details about procurement, legal or technical blockers for more accurate results.





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CHAPTER 3

Recommended Workflow

The AI handles the sequencing — you just ask your question.

Recommended Workflow

The tools chain together, with AI handling sequencing automatically to help you ask better questions.

Step 1: Find Account

Start with `find_account` **by name or** `find_record_by_crm_id`.

Step 2: Get Overview

Use `get_account_status` for a quick strategic read on risks and next steps.

Step 3: Go Deeper

Use `get_recent_account_activity` to investigate specific interactions.

Step 4: Ask a Specific Question

Use `ask_sales_ai_about_account` for risk analysis, stakeholder maps, or competitive signals.

Step 5: Add External Context

Layer in market intelligence via `use_account_company_news` for trigger events and news.

Plain language works

Ask: 'What's the status on the Acme Corp renewal?' The AI chains these tools automatically.





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CHAPTER 4

Supported AI Clients & How to Connect

Claude, ChatGPT, Copilot, Cursor — and more being added regularly.

Supported AI Clients

Backstory's MCP server uses StreamingHTTP protocol. These clients are confirmed working.

Claude Desktop

Full integration with history.
Recommended for most users.

✓ **Confirmed**

ChatGPT

Plus plan or greater required for
remote MCP access.

✓ **Confirmed**

Microsoft Copilot

Enterprise OAuth via Copilot Studio.
Requires admin setup.

✓ **Confirmed**

Cursor / n8n

Developer environment and workflow
automation support.

✓ **Confirmed**

Perplexity / Grok

Does not yet support StreamingHTTP
or MCP protocol.

✗ **Not supported**

+ Add Your Client

*Contact your CSM for integration
requests.*

Expanding Support

New clients are added regularly. Check with your Backstory CSM if your tool isn't listed.



How to Connect

Two authentication methods are available. OAuth is recommended for most users. API Key is for programmatic access.

01

Configure Client

Set your MCP client to use the `StreamingHTTP` protocol for communication.

02

Endpoint URL

Set the target URL:
`https://mcp.backstory.ai/mcp`

03

OAuth Flow

Complete the authentication flow when prompted in your web browser.

04

Start Querying

Begin using Backstory data directly within your preferred AI tool.

Access control & security

OAuth is based on existing user permissions. Revenue data never leaves the secure environment. All communications use HTTPS/TLS encryption and all MCP access is fully audit logged.





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CHAPTER 5

Scenarios & Query Starters by Role

Real workflows and ready-to-use prompts for AEs, CSMS, managers, and SDRs.

Use Case: EBR Prep in Under 5 Minutes

Scenario: CSM needs a full account briefing for an upcoming business review with Acme Corp's VP of Sales.

01

Find Account

Get account ID, ARR & open opportunities

02

Get Account Status

Surface risks, next steps & health sentiment

03

Ask Backstory AI

MAU metrics, stakeholders, ROI validation

04

Recent Activity

30-day meeting & email communication log

05

Company News

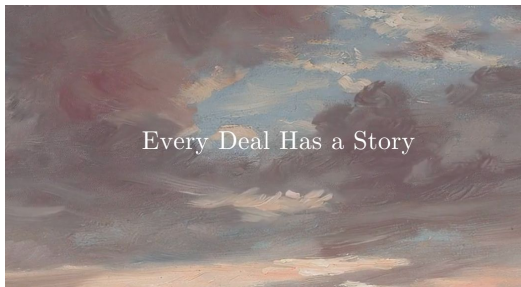
Latest earnings, exec changes & org updates

Full EBR Briefing — Generated in Under 5 Minutes

One question in Claude. The AI chains all 5 tools automatically, synthesizes the results, and delivers a structured briefing — **no Backstory, no Salesforce, no manual digging.**



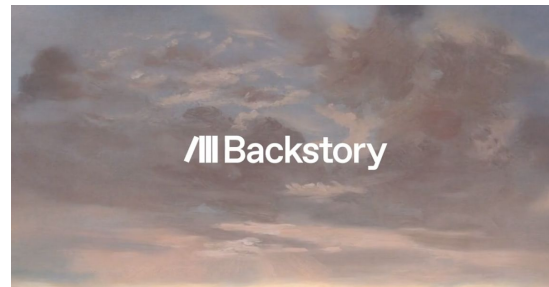
Scenarios in Practice: Rapid Insights



Scenario 01

Pre-Call Prep in 60 Seconds

- **Context:** 10 mins before a call with Acme Corp.
- **AI Logic:** find_account → get_status → ask_sales_ai.
- **Output:** Top 3 risks, next steps, and key themes delivered in <60s.
- **Value:** Zero manual digging in Salesforce or Backstory.



Scenario 02

Monday Pipeline Review Prep

- **Prompt:** "Which of my top 5 deals have the most risk?"
- **Action:** AI flags gaps in engagement (e.g., Deal B down 30 pts).
- **Outcome:** Walk into reviews with a pre-built action plan.
- **Edge:** Address flags before your manager even mentions them.



Scenarios in Practice: Efficiency Gains



Scenario 03

Executive Account Briefing

- **Prompt:** "Prepare a 5-bullet executive briefing on Acme Corp."
- **AI Logic:** `get_status` → `ask_sales_ai` → `company_news`
- **Result:** Data-backed brief in <60s without manual CRM digging.



Scenario 04

Deal Handoff in 2 Minutes

- **Need:** Briefing for TechCorp and DataFlow while teammate is away.
- **Execution:** AI synthesizes key contacts, activity, and first actions.
- **Outcome:** Personalized outreach leads to same-day replies.



Query Starters by Role: AE & CSM

Copy and paste these prompts into your AI tool. Replace [Account] or [Opportunity] with specific names.

Account Executive (AE)

Pre-call prep What's the current status on [Account] and what should I focus on in today's call?

Stakeholders Who at [Account] have we not engaged with recently that we should be talking to?

Deal risk What are the main risks on the [Opportunity] deal right now?

Commitments What follow-up items did we commit to on the last interaction with [Account]?

Re-engagement [Account] has gone quiet. What's the best angle for re-engaging them?

Customer Success (CSM)

Account health What's the overall health of [Account] and are there renewal risks I should know about?

Expansion Are there signals in our interaction history with [Account] that suggest expansion?

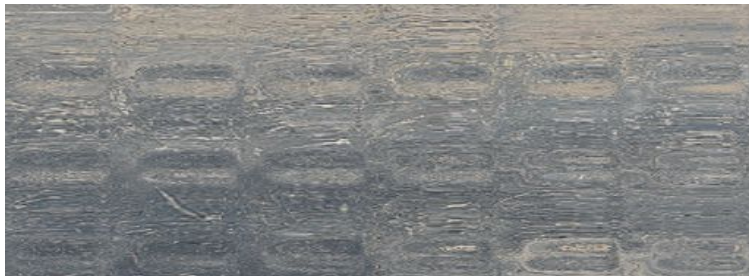
EBR prep Summarize the key themes, wins, and challenges with [Account] over the last quarter.

Champion check How is our relationship with [Contact] at [Account] trending?



Query Starters — Sales Manager & SDR

Paste directly into Claude or any connected AI tool. Replace brackets with your account or deal name.



Sales Manager

Pipeline review

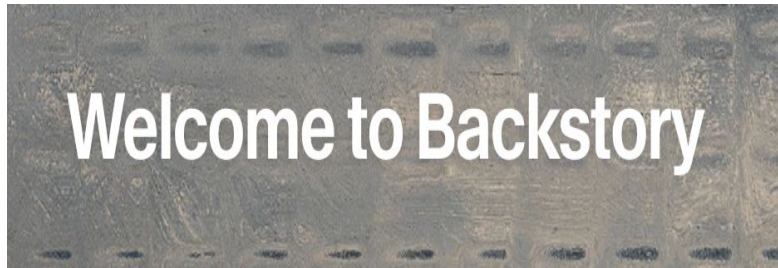
Which of my team's deals show the most risk heading into this week?

Forecast check

How confident should I be in current close dates based on engagement?

Deal deep dive

Walk me through everything that's happened on [Opportunity] in 30 days.



SDR

Warm path in

Does anyone on my team have a strong relationship with someone at [Account]?

Outreach

Is there anything in [Account]'s recent activity that makes this a good time to reach out?

Personalize

Based on recent conversations with [Account], what topics are relevant for outreach?





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CHAPTER 6

Best Practices & Troubleshooting

Seven habits, common issues, and answers to the questions teams ask first.

Getting Started with Backstory MCP

1. Connect



Connect

- Requires Backstory platform access
- Enable MCP via your Claude integration
- Authenticate with your CRM credentials
- No additional software to install

2. Configure



Configure

- Select which MCP tools to expose
- Set data access scopes by team/role
- Configure account ID resolution
- Test with a pilot account

3. Activate



Activate

- Train your team on prompt patterns
- Start with EBR/PBR prep workflows
- Expand to daily account briefings
- Measure time savings & adoption



Best Practices

1. Ask in Plain Language

You don't need to know tool names or parameters. Ask what you want to know. The AI handles tool selection and chaining automatically.

2. Use MCP for Pre-Call Prep

The highest-value use: a 60-second status check before any call. Build this habit first before expanding to other workflows.

3. AI Account Finder

Don't look up Backstory IDs manually. Let the AI call `find_account`. If results are unexpected, check name matches Salesforce exactly.

4. Ask Sales AI Synthesis

Get Status gives summaries. Ask Sales AI is for questions needing synthesis. Use it for answers, not just a data read.

5. Company News Context

`account_company_news` only works for public companies. Private accounts return empty—this is expected, not an error.

6. Next Steps as Actions

Status tools surface committed next steps from history. If you see an open commitment, assign an owner and timeline.



Troubleshooting & Support

Common issues and resolutions for Backstory MCP.

Account not found

Check the account name matches Salesforce (or CRM of choice) exactly. Try [find_record_by_crm_id](#) with the Salesforce ID.

Empty company news

Expected for private companies. The tool only surfaces news for publicly traded entities.

Connection failure

Verify [mcp.backstory.ai/mcp](#). Ensure your OAuth session hasn't expired and the API key is active.

Incorrect tool info

Check contact OCRs or account domain in Salesforce. Data hygiene is key to accuracy.

Still need assistance?

For technical support, contact your Backstory CSM. MCP answers rely on the data feeding them—maintain your Backstory UI hygiene for best results.



Your Backstory Support Ecosystem

Everything you need — from day one through the full lifecycle.

01

Your CSM

Primary point of contact for strategic support and journey guidance.

Reach out for:

- Strategy & adoption
- New use cases
- Urgent escalations

02

Technical Support

Hands-on investigation for bugs, integrations, and data issues.

Reach out for:

- Sync & API issues
- Data quality
- Product errors

support@backstory.ai

03

Help Center

Self-serve 24/7 library of guides and product documentation.

Find answers for:

- Feature walkthroughs
- Admin configuration
- Release notes

help.backstory.ai

04

Help Center Bot

Instant AI answers via natural language search.

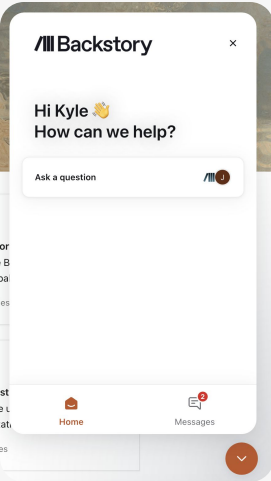
Best for:

- Quick how-to's
- Instant article search
- After-hours support



Where to go for help.

During training prep, during the session, or after — **these are your go-to resources.**

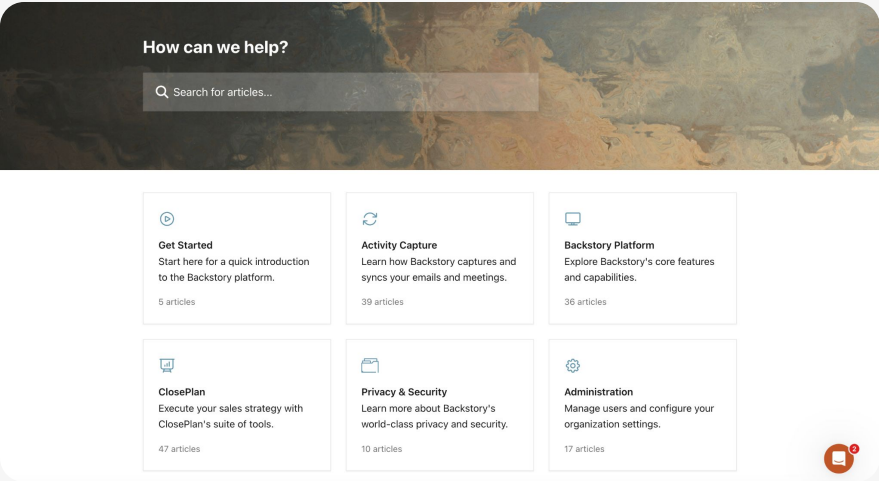


Help Center

Our [Help Center](#) gives you 24/7 access to hundreds of resources answering all of your questions.

Help Center Bot

Ask the bot quick questions and it will surface the resources you need instantly.



THANK YOU

Contact your Backstory CSM for any questions about MCP Server & Tools.

backstory.ai · hello@backstory.ai





Backstory

“The story didn’t change. The clarity did.”

JOHN CONSTABLE "STUDY OF A CLOUDY SKY"